

Georgetown Orthodox Christian Fellowship

Vespers: Tuesday, September 08, 2026

Memory of the Holy Martyrs Menodora, Metrodora, and Nymphodora

Feel free to read or chant during the service!

Stichera

Tone 2. *If You, O Lord, should mark iniquities, O Lord, who shall stand? For with You there is forgiveness.*

How can our lowly lips sing in praise * of the Virgin now born and extol her! * Holier is she than creation all. * She is rightly praised as more honorable * than the Cherubim as well as all Saints. * We laud her employing images and metaphors. * We call her the King's immovable throne and house * of the Most High; the salvation * of the world; God's holy place. * On the feast of her sacred birth * she grants to the faithful peace * and the great mercy.

Because of Your Name have I waited for You, O Lord; my soul has waited upon Your word, my soul has hoped in the Lord. All-holy Virgin, what spiritual * songs and hymns shall we sing now to praise you? * For you sanctified the entire world * when your barren mother gave birth to you. * Through you Eve was freed from cursed labor, * and Adam has been released from bonds of death through you. * And therefore the hosts of Angels celebrate with us. * Heaven and earth are rejoicing, * and the souls of the righteous * are applauding this sacred feast * and faithfully singing hymns * to glorify your nativity.

From the morning watch until night, from the morning watch let Israel trust in the Lord. What awesome songs did they sing to you * on that day when you were born, O Virgin? * There were girls who stood round about your crib * and they formed a chorus to celebrate, * looking on with wonderment and singing, * “The palace, of God the King of all was born today. * She shines forth, being the ark of the Lord's holiness. * The barren gates have been opened. * and God's gate has come forth, * introducing a holy birth * of virtue, awarding peace * and the great mercy.

Tone 4. *For with the Lord there is mercy and with Him is abundant redemption, and He will deliver Israel from all his iniquities.* Being beautifully dressed in gowns * that were dyed in martyric blood, * you, O virgin maidens, were chastely joined to Christ, * who in the Psalms and the Song is called * most handsome and beautiful. * Being God He has preserved * your virginity undefiled for eternity * in the heavenly bridal room, O Martyrs, and imperishable chambers, * not manufactured by human hands.

Praise the Lord, all you nations; praise Him, all you peoples. Even though you were physically * undeveloped, O blessed Saints, * you were most mature in your pious frame of mind. * The Holy Spirit empowered you * to wrestle that murderous, * serpentine primeval foe, * showing him to impotent. Therefore you received * crowns of glory, O Martyrs Menodora, Metrodora, Nymphodora, * for having championed the Trinity.

For His mercy is great towards us, and the truth of the Lord endures forever. Holy Martyrs extolled by all, * you did not disavow your faith * in Christ, even though you were tortured physically. * Your tender bodies were racked and scraped, * subjected to bludgeoning * and dismemberment and fire. * Your endurance of suffering won you the divine * crowns of victory, sisters Menodora, Metrodora, Nymphodora, * triad of saints of the Trinity.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Amen. At an Angel's prediction, a child all-holy of righteous Joachim and Anna, O Virgin, you came forth today; heaven and throne of God vessel of cleanliness foretold of joy for all the world
A forth today; heaven and throne of God, vessel of cleanliness, foretold of joy for all the world,
envoy of our Life, destruction of the curse, proxy of blessings. Therefore, at your nativity, O
Daughter called of God, plead for peace and great mercy for our souls.

Aposticha

Tone 2 O House of Ephratha. Οἶκος τοῦ Ἐφραθᾶ. Chorus of Prophets, leap for joy! For barren Anna *
conceived and bore a daughter. * Through her who is today born, your prophecies will come to pass.

Tone 2. Listen, O daughter, behold and incline your ear, and forget your people and your father's house.
For the King desired your beauty. Joachim, leap for joy * as you see Anna bear you * her womb's fruit, a
daughter, * who for the world will bring forth * redemption and the life of all.

The rich among the people shall entreat your favor. O ld age of Joachim * and barrenness of Anna, * rejoice,
for human nature, * which long ago became old, * through them will be made new again.

**Tone . Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of
ages. Amen.** Same Melody.

Mother of God, I pray * that you accept my praises, * even from these impure lips. * Reform me
of my vices, * and rid me of offenses all.

Apolytikion

Tone 1 As the Father and Spirit.

With our songs let us crown and extol the holy three * virgin sisters, united to each other and
to God. * They were manly in the way they defeated the enemy. * And now they guard us and
protect us who sing to them and say, * "Rejoice, devout Menodora, * and you, divine Metrodora, *
and Nymphodora, godly-minded Saint."

**Tone 4. Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Both now and ever, and unto the ages of
ages. Amen.** Your Nativity, O Theotokos, imparted joy to the entire earth, for out of you has risen the Sun of
Righteousness, Christ our God. He nullified the curse and instead gave His blessing; and
causing death to be neutralized, He granted us eternal life.

Troparion for Mary of Egypt Tone 8 In you the image was preserved with exactness, O Mother; for taking up
your cross, you did follow Christ, and by your deeds you did teach us to overlook the flesh, for it passes away,
but to attend to the soul since it is immortal. Wherefore, O righteous Mary, your spirit rejoices with the
Angels.